12 The Girl Who Hated Books

Warm up

Put the words in the correct order to get some quotes about books.

Confucius — learn something/You cannot/opening/without/a book

is like a/in a pocket/A book/garden carried — Chinese proverb

Henry Thoreau — wealth/the treasured/Books are/of the world

Now, write a book quote of your own.

You

Let's read a story about a girl who hated books until one day, when something strange happened.

Once there was a girl named Meena. She hated to read and she hated books. "They're always in the way," she said.

This was true because in her house books were everywhere. Not just on bookshelves and bedside tables, where books usually are, but in all sorts of places where books usually aren't.

There were books in dressers and drawers and desks, in closets and cupboards and chests. There were books on the sofa and books on the stairs, books crammed in the fireplace and stacked on the chairs.

Do you know how closets, cupboards and chests are different from each other?

Which word is a synonym for 'piled'?

Confucius: a Chinese scholar Henry Thoreau: an American author dressers: wooden furniture with shelves on top and cupboards below crammed: fitted tightly

Worse still, her parents were always bringing home MORE books. They read at breakfast and lunch and dinner.

"Please read," they would say to Meena. But she would stamp her foot and shout, "I hate books!" and when they tried to read aloud to her she would put her hands over her ears and shout even louder, "I HATE BOOKS!"

Meena's cat Max hated books too. When he was a little kitten, a thick atlas had fallen on his tail. Ever since then, he tried to stay on top of books rather than below them.

Why did Max prefer to stay on top of books rather than below them?

One morning Meena called Max for breakfast but Max didn't come. "Where could he be?" she wondered. She looked in the bathtub, under the stairs and on top of the clock. But she didn't find Max. Suddenly, she heard a loud "Meeeeeyooow!"

She ran into the dining room and there he was, stuck on top of the tallest stack of books in the house. It was made up of all the books her parents kept buying her and she kept refusing to read. At the bottom were big shiny picture books from when she was a baby. In the middle were alphabet books and nursery rhymes. At the top, right by the ceiling, were fairy tales and adventure stories. They were all covered in dust.

"Don't worry, Max," Meena called out to him. "I'll rescue you!" She stood on a stool, stretched forward. Her foot slipped; she lost her balance and started to slide.

CRASH! The books went flying. They fell every which way. As they fell, strange things began to happen. People and animals started falling out of the pages and tumbling on to the ground. They dropped one on top of the other, scattering the books and toppling the chairs. There were princes and princesses, fairies and frogs and a wolf. There were elephants, emperors, emus and elves and an assortment of monkeys and rabbits tangled up in themselves. Meena sat there in the middle of it all, too surprised to move. By now, she couldn't recognize the dining room at all. The elephant was balancing on a coffee table, juggling the good china plates. The monkeys had torn down the curtains and were using them as capes. And the rabbits were nibbling on the table legs.

"Stop!" cried Meena. "Go back!" But there was so much barking and grunting and thumping going on that no one heard her speak. She grabbed the nearest rabbit and tried to stuff him into a cookbook, but that scared him so much that he wiggled out of Meena's grasp and ran away. She opened another book and a flock of birds flew out. She slammed it shut again.

What were the noises heard in the dining room?

tumbling: falling downwards, often hitting the ground, without being injured toppling: becoming unsteady and falling down emus: birds usually found in Australia that cannot fly assortment: a collection of different things or of different types of the same thing juggling: throwing a set of three or more objects into the air, catching and throwing them again quickly, one at a time capes: pieces of clothing like a cloak without sleeves nibbling: taking small bites grunting: making short, rough sounds wiggled: moved from side to side or up and down in short, quick movements slammed: closed something with a very loud noise

"This won't work," sighed Meena. "I don't know who goes in which book." She thought for a minute. Then she picked up the nearest book and began to read. "Once upon a time," she read, "in a land far, far away …"

Slowly the creatures crept closer and closer to hear what happened next. Soon they were all sitting in a circle around her. When Meena reached the top of the second page, the fairies in the circle jumped up. "That's us!" they cried. "That's our page! That's our book! Get in!" They leapt out of the circle and dove into her lap and disappeared into the book.

Meena clapped it shut before they could get out again. Then she picked up another story. One by one she began reading all her books. One by one the creatures found out where they belonged. When her parents came in that afternoon, they couldn't believe their eyes. Not because the curtains were gone and the dishes were broken and the table legs were chewed up, but because there, sitting in the middle of the room, was Meena. She was reading a book!

Adapted and abridged

Manjusha Pawagi was born in Maharashtra. She moved with her family to Toronto at the age of three. She began her career as a journalist and a writer of children's books. *The Girl Who Hated Books* was her first attempt at fiction. It has been translated into eleven languages and is being made into an animated film.

In this section, we will:
- remember details about the story.
- learn how to analyse the structure of a story. (C-2.1, 2.2)

Make connections

Map the story

Answer the following questions based on the story.

1. A realistic story is based in the real world while a fantasy is set in a magical world. Is this story a realistic one or a fantasy? Give a reason for your answer.
2. Authors use imagery to help readers put themselves in the world of the story. They can do this by using words to help you see, hear or feel the things happening in the story. The author has used imagery related to sound and action or movement in this story.
   a. List six descriptions of sound in the story.
   b. List six action or movement words from the story.
3. What is the theme or the message of the story that the writer wants to share with us?

Deep dive

Answer the following questions with reference to context.

1. *Worse still, her parents were always bringing home MORE books. They read at breakfast and lunch and dinner.*

RECALL	INFER	ANALYSE
a. What were the different kinds of books that Meena's parents had bought for her?	b. Which word in these sentences is an antonym for 'better'? c. In what way was Meena different from her parents?	d. Do you think Meena was bad-mannered? Give a reason for your answer.

2. *When her parents came in that afternoon, they couldn't believe their eyes.*

RECALL	INFER	ANALYSE
a. What did Meena's parents see when they came home?	b. What does the idiom 'couldn't believe their eyes' mean?	c. Meena's interest in reading grew when she accidently discovered the stories in the books her parents had bought. How did you grow an interest in reading?

Read, reflect and write

1. Why do you think Meena hated books?
2. Why did Meena begin reading? What happened that led to this?
3. What advice would you give to a friend who says they do not enjoy reading?

Integrate

World Book Day is celebrated on 23 April each year. Have a brainstorming session in class on ways to celebrate this day. Note them down and when the day comes next, organize some of the activities that you and your classmates like best.

Word wall

In this section, we will:
- match collective nouns to their illustrations.
- learn about the different kinds of books.

(C-4.1, 4.2)

Collective nouns

Collective nouns are names of a collection or a group of people or things.

Example: A group of birds is called a flock.

Here are some collective nouns. Match them with the pictures.

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.
6.
7.
8.
9.
10.

pack
gaggle
brood
litter
colony
crash
swarm
pride
troop
herd

Kinds of books

An atlas is a book that shows us the maps of the world.

Here is a list of some other types of books. Write a short definition for each. Use your dictionary if you need help.

dictionary comic diary catalogue encyclopaedia

Grammar time

In this section, we will:
- learn about imperative sentences. (C-3.4, 4.2)

Imperative sentences

Read these sentences.

- Once there was a girl named Meena.
- Where could Max be?
- Read books.
- I hate books!

Each of these sentences is a different type of sentence.

A sentence is a group of words that expresses a complete thought.

There are four types of sentences.

Type of sentence	What it does	Punctuation mark	Examples
Declarative a statement	gives information	. Full Stop	• Once there was a girl named Meena. • Meena did not read books.
Interrogative a question	asks questions	? Question mark	Where could Max be?
Imperative a request or command	makes a request or gives an order	. Full Stop ! Exclamation	• Please read. • Stop! Go back!
Exclamatory an exclamation	shows surprise or a strong feeling	! Exclamation	I HATE BOOKS!

Let us learn a little more about imperative sentences.

ANCHOR CHART

IMPERATIVE SENTENCES

An imperative sentence is used to express a command, an instruction, an order or a request.

- Most imperative sentences end with a full stop.

  Examples: Fetch your umbrellas.
  Read a book.

- Some strong commands and exclamations end with an exclamation mark.

  Examples: Watch out!
  Come here at once!

- All commands and requests are made to the listener but we do not use the word *you*.

  Examples: (You) Come here.
  (You) Stop doing that!
  (You) Open the door, please.

Here are a few more examples:

Request	Please stand in a queue.
Command	Stand in a queue.
Strong command	Queue up!

1. Identify the types of sentences in each set. Place the correct punctuation mark at the end of each sentence.

a. It is a very cold day _____
Brrrr! I'm freezing _____
Please give me a scarf and a pair of gloves _____
Are you warm now _____

b. Thomas Edison was a great inventor _____
He invented the light bulb _____
How clever Edison was _____
Do you know what else he invented _____
Tell me everything you know about Edison _____

2. Look at this picture. Write down five imperative sentences that the teacher could say. You may include the sentences that your teacher says to the class.

In this section, we will:
- learn the spelling rules for words ending in 'c'. (C-3.4)

Spelling

Words ending in c

Words ending in c take 'k' after the c before adding *-ed* or *-ing*.

Examples: frolic—frolicked, froclicking

Convert the following words as shown in the example above.

Word	-ed	-ing
1. picnic		
2. panic		
3. mimic		

Write well

In this section, we will:
- learn how to write a book review. (C-3.2, 3.4)

Writing a book review

Think of your favourite book. Fill in the graphic organizer below and then write a review of the book in your notebook.

MY BOOK REVIEW

Book title:

Author:

This is a _____ about _____ (genre)

Summary (the main events of the book without giving away the end): _____

_____

I give this book ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ stars.

You should/should not read this book because _____

In this section, we will:
- listen to some facts about books.
- speak on a topic related to books.
(C-1.1, 2.1)

Listen and speak well

1. Listen to some interesting facts about the history of writing and books and tick the correct answers.

a. Writing was invented about
   i. 50,000 years ago. ◯
   ii. 5,000 years ago. ◯
   iii. 500 years ago. ◯

b. People invented writing because they
   i. wanted to keep a check on things they bought and sold. ◯
   ii. wanted to start a library. ◯
   iii. wanted books to read before they went to bed at night. ◯

c. Papyrus is made from plants found near
   i. the River Ganges. ◯
   ii. the River Mississippi. ◯
   iii. the River Nile. ◯

d. Paper and printing were invented in
   i. Nepal. ◯
   ii. China. ◯
   iii. Sri Lanka. ◯

e. Johannes Gutenberg invented
   i. the printing press. ◯
   ii. digital books. ◯
   iii. clay tablets. ◯

2. Take turns to speak on the topic: Books are our best friends.